

phases the government's commitment to affordable housing. It proposes constructing 30 million houses under the PM Awas Yojana in both rural and urban areas. The PM Awas Yojana Urban 2.0 specifically targets the housing needs of 10 million urban poor and middle class families—backed by an investment of ₹10 lakh crore—including central assistance of ₹2.2 lakh crore over the next five years. This ambitious plan aims to provide decent housing for low-income families and marginalised communities, improving their quality of life and stimulating job creation in the construction sector, which is crucial for economic recovery and growth.

RENEWABLE ENERGY REVOLUTION

The Pradhan Mantri Suryodaya Yojana is a landmark initiative aimed at empowering 10 million households with solar panels and providing 300 units of free electricity monthly. This programme promotes renewable energy adoption, significantly reducing electricity costs. By investing in solar energy, India enhances its energy security, reduces dependency on fossil fuels, and positions itself as a leader in the global clean energy movement. Additionally, the government will invest ₹600 crore in the National Green Hydrogen Mission, further supporting the transition to sustainable energy sources.

BOOSTING INFRA, MANUFACTURING

The Budget's substantial allocation for manufacturing and infrastructure development highlights a strong commitment to growth. A new credit guarantee scheme for MSMEs will provide collateral-free term loans of up to ₹100 crore, while Sidbi will open 24 new

branches in major MSME clusters. Sectors such as textiles, electronics, and pharmaceuticals are set to benefit from increased funding and support. By creating a favourable environment for foreign direct investment and enhancing domestic manufacturing, the government aims to position India as a global manufacturing hub. Improved infrastructure, including transport and logistics networks, will facilitate smoother supply chains and boost productivity across various sectors, driving economic growth and creating jobs.

INVESTING IN HUMAN CAPITAL

Recognising the importance of a skilled workforce, the Budget emphasises employment and skill development. Key initiatives include a central outlay of ₹2 lakh

THE ROLE OF PPPs

Public-private partnerships (PPPs) are essential for achieving the goals of Viksit Bharat. By combining public resources with private sector expertise and investment, PPPs can enhance efficiency, drive innovation, and accelerate project delivery. They enable the government to leverage private funding for infrastructure projects, share risks, and improve service quality.

This collaboration is particularly important in sectors like renewable energy, housing, and manufacturing, where both public and private sectors can work together to create sustainable solutions.

CONCLUSION

The Union Budget 2024-25 outlines a comprehensive road map

RECOGNISING THE IMPORTANCE OF A SKILLED WORKFORCE, THE BUDGET EMPHASISES EMPLOYMENT AND SKILL DEVELOPMENT

crore to provide opportunities for 41 million youth over five years. This includes wage support for new employees, incentives for additional employment, and skills training programmes. An internship scheme will offer opportunities in 500 top companies for 10 million youth over five years, with allowances and support from these companies. These programmes aim to equip young people with the skills needed for the evolving job market, enhancing employability and contributing to economic resilience.

for India's growth trajectory, reinforcing the vision of a sustainable and inclusive future.

As we move forward, it is crucial for stakeholders across sectors, including public and private entities, to align their efforts with these transformative initiatives.

Together, we can build a brighter, more sustainable future for all. **BT**

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